

Vibethon 2026: 30-Hour Evaluation Protocol

Adapted from the 24-Hour Evaluation Framework for the Hiring Hack 2026

This document establishes a standardized, multi-tiered evaluation framework tailored specifically for assessing full-stack web applications and AI agent integrations built during the 30-hour sprint format of Vibethon 2026.

1. COMPREHENSIVE MARKING RUBRICS (100 POINTS TOTAL)

CATEGORY	PERFORMANCE TIER	DETAILED EVALUATION CRITERIA
1.1 Core Full-Stack Engineering & Robustness Weight: 25 Points	Excellent (21–25)	All CRUD operations function flawlessly across endpoints with zero deadlocks. Data includes strict server-side schema validations, robust security hashes (e.g., bcrypt), and persistent session state handling (JWT tokens). Database relationships show optimized indexing and clean schemas.
	Good (16–20)	Full-stack pipeline works well and data streams seamlessly. Basic auth and CRUD endpoints are stable, but data validation layers or extreme boundary exception handling (e.g., negative integers, overflow inputs) contain minor gaps.
	Passable (10–15)	The system runs, but portions of the CRUD flow are incomplete, unstable, or rely heavily on static mocks. Basic security parameters are absent, or session persistence fails upon browser reloads.
	Poor (0–9)	The backend fails to execute, presents unresolved compilation faults, database connectivity crashes, or bypasses server architecture completely using browser-based local storage.
1.2 AI-Emergent Integration & Contextual Logic Weight: 25 Points	Excellent (21–25)	The AI features dynamic, self-optimizing, or predictive behavior (e.g., tracking data changes over time or resolving semantic, non-exact match parameters). The engine dynamically adjusts its context model based on real-time database inputs without hardcoded strings.
	Good (16–20)	AI functionalities behave reliably and connect smoothly with system inputs (e.g., natural language command translation). However, the logic maps to static transactional API prompts rather than demonstrating truly evolving behavior over historical data iterations.
	Passable (10–15)	The AI integration acts as a superficial, unlinked element (e.g., a basic chat module sidebar that operates in a sandbox without visibility or cross-mutation permissions on user data entries).
	Poor (0–9)	AI elements fail completely, timeout on standard payload requests, provide corrupt output blocks, or are emulated using static text logs.
1.3 UI/UX Excellence & User-Centered Design Weight: 20 Points	Excellent (17–20)	The interface layout minimizes cognitive workload and formats seamlessly across mobile and desktop viewport frames. Typography and visual tones mirror domain identities (e.g., futuristic cyber-tech or enterprise utility). Includes highly intuitive navigation matrices.

CATEGORY	PERFORMANCE TIER	DETAILED EVALUATION CRITERIA
	Good (13–16)	Polished, scannable visual controls with clean data breakdown tables. Basic navigation flows smoothly, though edge responsive sizes present isolated asset squeezing or minor padding issues.
	Passable (8–12)	Functional UI layout that lacks design consistency, scaling properties, or style accents. Convoluted paths to find primary menu items with high visual noise.
	Poor (0–7)	Broken, completely unstyled presentation frames where structural components block interaction layers or input fields.
1.4 Innovation, Product Viability & Track Relevance Weight: 15 Points	Excellent (13–15)	Highly original approach to resolving explicit user friction targets. The resulting workflow provides realistic utility, features clear market viability, and offers immediate adoptability.
	Good (10–12)	The application targets domain requirements correctly. The functional layout represents a working, complete execution, but builds on boilerplate templates or standard system tracking tropes without unique features.
1.5 Deployment, DevOps & Production Reliability Weight: 15 Points	Excellent (13–15)	The full-stack application is deployed live over secure HTTPS to a public cloud pipeline (e.g., Vercel, Render, AWS). Includes clean configuration records, hidden environment parameters, and secure environment isolation.
	Good (10–12)	The application is hosted via a public web link, but certain assets or secondary endpoint actions return asset path failures or CORS access faults due to production deployment configuration oversights.

2. CHRONOLOGICAL 30-HOUR MILESTONE MATRIX

To account for the 30-hour timeline (expanded from 24 hours to accommodate deeper full-stack integration and OAuth workflows), the development checkpoints are mapped out below:

TIME BLOCK	MILESTONE TARGET	EXPECTED DELIVERABLES & PROOFS	WEIGHT
Hours 0–4	Architecture & Git Setup	Problem statement specification, entity-relationship diagrams (ERD) drafted, main/dev branch system creation, working local boilerplates.	10%
Hours 5–10	Authentication & Page 1	Secure login/logout functionality via backend data validation, hashed passwords stored, initial responsive landing workspace (Page 1) online.	15%
Hours 11–16	OAuth 2.0 & Security Gate	Integration of social logins (Google/GitHub) and secure JWT/session middleware configuration.	15%
Hours 17–23	Core CRUD & AI Engine	Primary operating view (Page 2) built, complete interactive CRUD pipeline mutations, real-time context-linked dynamic AI operations functional.	30%
Hours 24–27	DevOps & Cloud Deployment	App built for production, server hidden environment arrays set up, system reachable via public HTTPS URL link with functional endpoints.	20%

TIME BLOCK	MILESTONE TARGET	EXPECTED DELIVERABLES & PROOFS	WEIGHT
Hours 28–30	Demo & Project Pitch	Functional technical deployment presentation, robust system validation performance during judge QA evaluations.	10%

3. VIBETHON 30-HOUR LIVE EVALUATION SHEET

Team Name / ID:

Evaluator Name:

Assigned Track:

☐ FinTech

☐ EduTech

☐ AI Agents

☐ Enterprise SaaS

ID	EVALUATION MILESTONES & GRADING METRICS	MAX PTS	SCORE
PHASE 1: Ideation, Architecture & Repository Setup (Hours 0–4)			
1.1	Problem Calibration: Clear problem statement target, persona alignment, and specified AI use case workflow.	4	
1.2	Data Schema & Architecture: Tech stack locked; structural Entity-Relationship Diagrams (ERD) support tracking metrics.	4	
1.3	Boilerplate Framework: Live main/dev branch code setup; initial local server environments compile successfully.	2	
PHASE 2: Authentication, OAuth & Dashboard Layout [Page 1] (Hours 5–16)			
2.1	Traditional Auth Pipeline: Secure hashed passwords stored; sign up/login/logout endpoints process securely.	5	
2.2	OAuth 2.0 Integration: Successful third-party social login handshake (Google/ GitHub) protecting route access.	5	
2.3	Page 1 Design System: Responsive navigation shell running across mobile and web frames with zero component clips.	5	
PHASE 3: Core Functional CRUD & Emergent AI Integration [Page 2] (Hours 17–23)			
3.1	Page 2 Technical Shell: Main processing workspace is fully operational and responsive; high-empathy UI styling.	10	
3.2	End-to-End Content CRUD: Secure data modifications operate live without browser failures; input validation is present.	10	
3.3	Adaptive AI Flow: Live non-hardcoded AI models parse transaction values or strings to generate dynamic context.	10	
PHASE 4 & 5: DevOps, Cloud Hosting & Pitch Delivery (Hours 24–30)			
4.1	Cloud Infrastructure: App successfully built and deployed to public URL link running safely over secure HTTPS.	10	
4.2	System Hardening & Secrets: Configuration arrays protect private keys (.env); database connection handles faults gracefully.	10	
5.1	Technical Presentation & Quality QA: Product demonstrates real viability and robust deployment stability under questioning.	15	
FINAL RECONCILIATION TOTAL SCORE		100	/100

AUTOMATION DISQUALIFICATION & PENALTY CLAUSES

[] **Mocked AI Behavior (-20 Points):** The system uses hardcoded text structures or local conditional text files to simulate artificial intelligence processing without invoking true dynamic API endpoints.

[] **Pure Localhost Dependency (-15 Points):** The codebase cannot run outside of the developer's local machine due to hardcoded absolute system file pathways or missing configuration documentation.

[] **Wholesale Plagiarism (Disqualification):** Repository logs confirm the workspace was copied directly from existing public repos with zero creative active commits during the 30-hour sprint.

Evaluator Signature: _____

Verification Timestamp: _____